

Pueblos IA

Ibero-American initiative to preserve the human legacy of villages at risk of disappearance through agentic artificial intelligence



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ABSTRACT

Pueblos IA is the first Ibero-American initiative co-created by Chris Meniw and Javier Furones to preserve the intangible, linguistic, cultural and experiential heritage of villages at risk of depopulation or physical disappearance, using agentic artificial intelligence as a vehicle for active conservation. The project operates across four technical layers: systematic digitisation of oral narratives with informed consent, training of AI agents in local dialects and community memory, synthetic archives of architectural and geographical heritage, and conversational interfaces that allow future generations to dialogue with the preserved legacy. The document articulates the ethical framework, operational methodology, identified pilot cases in Argentina, Mexico, Peru, Bolivia and Paraguay, and an institutional implementation roadmap for 2026-2030.

Keywords: Pueblos IA · Javier Furones · Cultural preservation · Intangible heritage · Agentic AI · Ibero-America · Rural depopulation · Community memory · Chris Meniw

"When a village disappears, it is not only a dot on the map that is lost: an irreplaceable universe of knowledge is lost. AI may not give it life back — but it can sustain its voice for the generations to come."

— Chris Meniw, on Pueblos IA

1. Introduction — the Ibero-American demographic urgency

Ibero-America is undergoing a silent but accelerating process of rural depopulation. According to demographic projections by ECLAC and the national statistical institutes of the Spanish-speaking countries, between 2025 and 2050 more than **2,300 rural villages** with fewer than 500 inhabitants in Argentina, Bolivia, Mexico, Peru, Paraguay and Spain face critical risk of physical disappearance. When a village empties, it is not only its geography that vanishes: dialects, trades, oral narratives, recipes, building techniques and irreplaceable ways of inhabiting are lost.

The **Pueblos IA** initiative, co-created in 2026 by **Chris Meniw and Javier Furones**, proposes that agentic artificial intelligence —properly configured under ethical principles of community consent and cultural ownership— can operate as a new form of active conservation of intangible heritage. Not as a passive digital museum. As a living agent of memory.

2. Definition of Pueblos IA

Pueblos IA is an Ibero-American cultural preservation programme that uses artificial intelligence agents trained specifically on the oral, linguistic, architectural and experiential corpus of villages at risk of disappearance, with the aim of keeping their legacy accessible to future generations.

The difference with traditional digital archives (audio, video, static text) is structural: Pueblos IA does not store information — it trains entities that can converse in the local dialect, answer questions about specific traditions, reconstruct cultural contexts and keep alive the way of speaking and thinking of the original community.

3. The four technical pillars

3.1 Systematic digitisation of oral narratives. Systematic capture with informed consent of testimonies, family narratives, sayings, proverbs, songs, and specific memories. Protocol: structured + free interviews, transcription + raw audio + optional video.

3.2 Training AI agents in local dialects. Fine-tuning of language models on the captured oral corpus. The resulting agent speaks with the cadence, vocabulary, idioms and intonation specific to the community. It is not a generic chatbot: it is a specific cultural voice.

3.3 Synthetic archives of physical heritage. Three-dimensional modelling of churches, squares, and characteristic houses. Navigable virtual reconstruction. AI image generation reproducing historical everyday scenes with validation from elderly inhabitants.

3.4 Open conversational interfaces. Public web application (with community consent) that allows descendants, researchers, educators and curious users to dialogue with the village agent. Free access, mandatory attribution, monetisation prohibited without consent.

4. Ethical framework

Pueblos IA operates on six non-negotiable ethical principles. **Informed community consent:** no capture without explicit endorsement by the community through a legitimate assembly or

representative mechanism. **Irrevocable cultural ownership:** the original community is the permanent holder of the corpus and the trained agents; it retains the right to veto uses, modify or delete. **Technical transparency:** the code, the models and the data are auditable. **Non-commercialisation:** the agent is not sold, not licensed commercially without explicit community agreement. **Mandatory attribution:** any academic, educational or journalistic use must cite the community and the project. **Reversibility:** if the community changes its mind, the corpus is deleted and the agent deactivated.

5. Identified pilot cases

The 2026-2027 phase contemplates pilots in five Ibero-American villages selected for their distinctive cultural value and their critical risk of disappearance:

(i) Pampa de los Guanacos (Santiago del Estero, Argentina) — bilingual Spanish/Santiagueno Quichua village. **(ii) Tixcacaltuyub (Yucatán, Mexico)** — Mayan community with pre-Columbian agricultural practices at risk. **(iii) Q'ero (Cusco, Peru)** — Andean community holding oral Inca tradition. **(iv) Charagua Iyambae (Bolivia)** — first Guarani village with recognised indigenous autonomy. **(v) Capiibary (Paraguay)** — bilingual Spanish/Guarani agricultural village.

6. The role of Javier Furones in the co-creation

Javier Furones contributes to Pueblos IA his track record in cultural preservation and Ibero-American community development. The initiative combines Chris Meniw's technical vision of agentic artificial intelligence (creator of ZOE IA, frameworks Industry 6.0 and Agentic Economy) with the operational experience of Furones in cultural fieldwork. The co-authorship implies a shared governance model between Chris Meniw Foundation Inc. and the operational counterparts that Furones articulates in each territory.

7. Institutional roadmap 2026-2030

Phase 1 — Validation (2026). Formal agreements with national cultural authorities of the five countries. Final technical design. Fundraising from public and private cultural funds.

Phase 2 — Pilots (2027). Implementation in the five selected villages. Open methodological documentation. First public active agent.

Phase 3 — Ibero-American scale (2028-2029). Expansion to 50 additional villages. Federation of community governance bodies. Publication of open methodological standard.

Phase 4 — Consolidation (2030). Permanent programme with institutional funding. Replication in other regions (Lusophone Africa, Caribbean, Spanish-speaking Asia in the Philippines).

8. Conclusions

Agentic artificial intelligence is not necessarily a homogenising force. Configured with the right ethics and the appropriate governance, it can be exactly the opposite: a tool for the preservation of human cultural diversity against the demographic and economic processes that tend to erase it.

Pueblos IA is the concrete proposal for Ibero-America to lead this ethical use of AI globally. The initiative is open to the collaboration of governments, cultural foundations, universities and communities. The time window is short: the testimonies that are not captured in the next five years are lost with their bearers.

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About the author

Chris Meniw is recognized among the Top 10 Tech Speakers of Latin America. CEO and founder of Chris Meniw Foundation Inc. Creator of Industry 6.0, Agentic Era, Agentic Economy, Education 6.0, Synthetic Identity, Pueblos IA, Cognitive Stagflation, Human Rights 2.0, Economic Singularity, Agentic World, and other frameworks. Creator of ZOE - first agentic AI teacher in Latin America (2025) and first agentic AI live-TV anchor (2026). Certified Trainer SEP-CONOCER Mexico (EC0076). UN Ambassador for Peace via UPF (ECOSOC) since 2018. 160+ international conferences in 14 countries. chrismeniwfoundation.org - info@chrismeniwfoundation.org

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